INNOVATION CHALLENGE

Mass-Affluent Wealth Advice

Team alignment before we start Design Thinking

1. **Understand the challenge**
2. **Separate facts from assumptions**
3. **Choose a customer and pain point**
4. **Only then explore solutions**

Prepared for team discussion - 13.10.2026

What are we trying to solve?

Start with the official question, then use a simpler working formulation to guide discussion.

OFFICIAL CHALLENGE

"How are mass affluent clients served with wealth management advice and where are the gaps? How can we find more ways to offer more value to customers during the process?"

WORKING GOAL

How can we give mass-affluent customers useful, affordable financial guidance that helps them achieve their goals and strengthens their relationship with the bank?

Preparation framing - not yet a team-approved scope or solution.

Sources: docs/challenges/00-overview.md; docs/my-research/01-start-here-challenge-basics-and-school-preparation.md

Who are we talking about?

The labels overlap. Choose a real market and customer group instead of importing one global threshold.

Mass affluent

A customer group with meaningful savings, income or investment potential - below the most intensive private-banking relationship. The exact definition varies by market.

Premium

A service proposition or tier. It may add a named banker, planning, video/phone access, preferential pricing or other benefits. A mass-affluent customer may already be Premium.

Private banking

A more intensive proposition for wealthier or more complex relationships, with dedicated advisers and specialist access.

Mass affluent = customer description | Premium = service proposition

Source: preparation research and public examples summarized in docs/my-research/02-mass-affluent-customers-bank-services-and-retention.md

What do we know - and what is still a hypothesis?

Research is useful, but it is not the same as validated customer evidence.

DOCUMENTED

Public services exist

Premium planning, banker access and automated advice already exist in some markets. We should not assume "there is no advice."

REPORTED

Expert observations

Branch capacity, paperwork, confusing tools, education needs, simpler workflows and assisted digital support recur in the internal interview.

HYPOTHESIS

Possible customer pain

Customers may struggle to understand a proposal, get help at the right moment, complete the action or know what to do afterwards.

NOT DECIDED

Solution

No chatbot, platform, app or operating model has been selected. Ideas are inputs for testing, not team decisions.

Best next move: validate the pain with a specific market, recent customer experiences and the real current journey.

Sources: expert transcript; public service examples; evidence caveats in docs/working-context.md

A customer journey to investigate

This is an investigation map - not a claim that every bank or customer follows the same process.

1	2	3	4	5	6
Recognise need	**Find help**	**Describe goals**	**Understand proposal**	**Complete action**	**Review progress**
What should I do with my money?	Where do I start?	What do I need, when, and why?	Does this fit me?	Can I sign/fund it easily?	Am I still on track?

Question: where does the customer become uncertain, stop, repeat information, or seek help elsewhere?

Source: docs/my-research/03-solving-our-challenge-with-design-thinking.md

What are others already doing?

Examples show possible operating models - they do not prove what our target customer needs.

Raiffeisen Serbia

Premium publicly includes personal banker access, video contact and planning across saving/investing, financing, protection and retirement.

Lesson: existing human and planning capabilities may already cover part of the need.

Tatra banka

Premium customers can have different care models, including a shared team or named banker.

Lesson: human support can be organised by need and service model - not only one dedicated adviser per customer.

Raiffeisen Czech

Public disclosure describes automated advice with employee involvement on request, with a defined one-off scope.

Lesson: automated advice exists; the opportunity may be continuity, explanation or follow-up.

Digital providers

Finax / ING / Moneyfarm show digital onboarding, portfolio journeys and tiered human support.

Lesson: the full journey matters - from intention through funding and monitoring.

What part of the current RBI journey needs improvement - rather than what new platform should we build?

Sources: public examples listed in docs/my-research/05-sources-and-further-reading.md

Possible directions - only after we validate the pain

Carry hypotheses into the workshop, but let customer evidence determine what deserves a prototype.

Explain better

One-page explanation linking a recommendation to goal, cost, risk and alternatives.

Human help with context

Easy escalation to a person without making the customer repeat everything.

Wealth health check

A short conversation that identifies the next useful financial action - even if no product is sold.

Goal review

Help the customer understand whether they are still on track after the initial decision.

Guided first-investment journey

Reduce confusion between interest, profiling, recommendation, signing and funding.

Education first

Short approved content that improves understanding before a recommendation or conversation.

AI/chatbot can be a delivery option - but it is not the problem statement.

Source: docs/my-research/04-wealth-advice-improvement-ideas-and-tests.md

How we propose to work as a team

The output of the first discussion should be a research focus - not a finished product idea.

1

UNDERSTAND

Choose market/user
Map today
Mark evidence & assumptions

→

2

EMPATHIZE

Hear recent customer experiences
Compare banker observations

→

3

IDEATE

Generate multiple ways to solve one focused problem

→

4

PROTOTYPE + TEST

Build something small
Test one uncertain assumption

→

5

BUSINESS CASE

Customer value
Costs / feasibility
Next pilot + measures

For our first live session: stay mostly in Understand. Later stages remain unfinished until the team actually does them.

Source: RBI Innovation Box notes and docs/my-research/03-solving-our-challenge-with-design-thinking.md

What should we leave the meeting with?

Three decisions would be more valuable than ten solution ideas.

1. **Which market and customer?**
   Choose one network bank and a specific customer group with a concrete need.

2. **Where is the pain?**
   Choose one or two journey moments to investigate - and state what evidence supports them.

3. **What do we need to learn next?**
   Agree which customer experiences, current-system facts or banker observations we need before ideation.

Facilitation rule: first agree on the problem -> then choose what to test.

APPENDIX

Evidence and source notes

Use these as inputs and guardrails. Customer outcomes still need validation in the selected market.

Project sources

docs/challenges/00-overview.md
docs/challenges/01-research.md
docs/challenges/02-understand.md
docs/team-research/Innovation_School_English_Transcript-Veljko.txt
docs/my-research/01-...school-preparation.md
docs/my-research/02-...bank-services-and-retention.md
docs/my-research/03-...design-thinking.md

Public examples referenced in research

Raiffeisen Serbia Premium and financial planning
Tatra banka Premium care models
Raiffeisenbank Czech automated-advice disclosure
Finax digital investment journey
ING Smart Invest
Moneyfarm service tiers
ESMA MiFID II / suitability guidance

Evidence discipline: public pages show advertised capabilities; the expert transcript reports experience; neither proves adoption, satisfaction or group-wide performance.